

Heather Hernandez

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PERSONAL STATEMENT

Junior Applied Scientist with 2 years of commercial experience across Data/AI/ML. I learn fast, ask a lot of questions, and care about leaving code clearer than I found it. Core tools: AWS, Kafka.

CAREER HISTORY

Junior Applied Scientist, BrightPath Solutions

2024-01 — Present | Hayleyberg

- Migrated ad-hoc notebooks into versioned PyTorch pipelines with reproducible runs and tracked experiments.
- Lifted recommendation click-through by 15% through feature engineering and retraining cadence in Databricks.
- Built the feature store that 15 downstream models now read from, ending duplicated feature logic.

EDUCATION AND TRAINING

PhD, Communications

West Todd National University | 2018 — 2023

GPA 3.8/4.0

Bachelor, Communications

Christinaport Institute of Technology | 2017

SKILLS & TOOLS

AWS — Working knowledge

Kafka — Working knowledge

PyTorch — Intermediate

Databricks — Intermediate

JavaScript — Working knowledge

C++ — Intermediate

PERSONAL PROJECTS

AWS utility library

Open-source helper library for AWS, ~900 GitHub stars. Wrote the docs and handled issue triage.

Personal finance tracker

Self-hosted spend tracker built with AWS. Deliberately kept the data local rather than using a hosted service.

Charity chatbot

Built a C++ assistant for a local charity to answer volunteer questions; retired it once they moved to a supported platform.

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

"Framing effects in crisis communication" - accepted at a peer-reviewed workshop, 2023.

"Trust signals in digital public messaging" - co-authored conference paper, 2024.

LANGUAGE SKILLS

English – Native